

INDIVIDUAL DEVELOPMENT PLAN



On the following pages is a template
that you can use to create your IDP.

This is intended to be printed out so you can refer back to it and update it as needed. Having a printed copy in a place where you will see it regularly will help to remind you of your main priorities so you can minimize distractions.

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Individual Development Plan

Goal setting is an important predictor of success in university and can help you transition successfully into your chosen career. By planning and aligning your activities with your goals, and tracking your progress, you can enhance your well-being and greatly increase your chances of achieving your goals.

Dates

Enter the date range for your IDP:

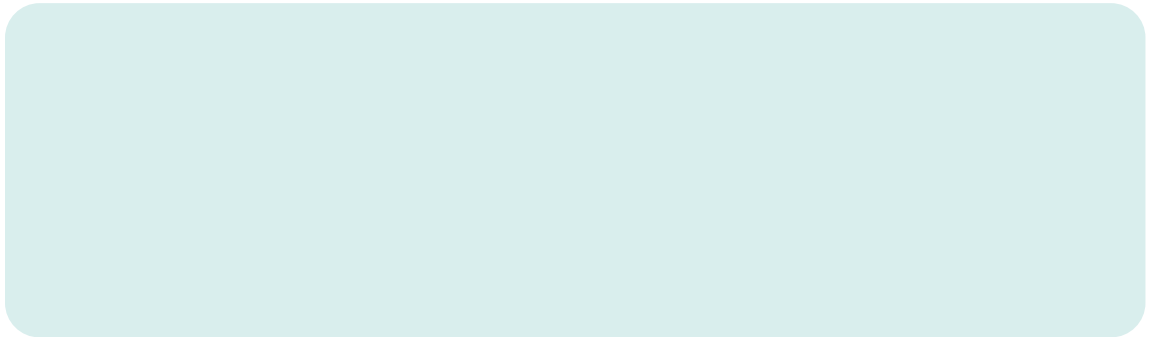
START DATE: _____ END DATE: _____

Your needs and interests will change over time, so it is important to revisit your IDP regularly.

Vision & Priorities

Summarize your vision and priorities for the next 6-12 months below. See the Vision and Priorities exercise in the Master Planner for guidance.

Ask yourself: how do you want the next 6-12 months to be the same or different from the previous year?



Goals

Establish 3-5 goals that will help you pursue your vision and priorities.

- ▶ Transfer the goals you selected in Set Your Goals exercise from the Master Planner

Use the SMART goals templates on the following pages to write out your selected goals.

- ▶ On the next page is an overview and example of how to use the SMART template.
- ▶ For more details on how to create SMART goals, see the Create Your IDP section of the Master Planner.

Be SMART

The Create Your IDP section of the Master Planner provides details on SMART goals. Here is an overview:

Specific

Describe each of the goals you prioritized. Try to be specific. Use action verbs to create a clear list of “to do” items for your goals and/or activities. Think about who, what, and where. Indicate what domain(s) this goal is focused on:

- **Academic** (e.g. conference proposal)
- **Personal Well-being** (e.g. healthy eating)
- **Professional/Career Development** (e.g. leadership experience)

My goal is to learn about policy careers in government or non-profit organizations where I can use my expertise in wildlife habitats. Activities that will help me to get there: meet people who are working in policy or environmental careers (e.g. through LinkedIn or career events), go to the Career Planning Service Resource Centre to find books and resources on policy or environmental careers.

Measurable

Explain how you will evaluate whether the goal is complete. Set criteria that are measurable so you can chart your progress. Include a due date. Use the goal type to help you determine how to measure it:

- **Project:** has an end (e.g. write an article) - define outcome/deliverable and create a due date
- **Habit:** ongoing (e.g. sleep 8 hours per night) - define aim and create a schedule to monitor maintenance
- **Development:** ongoing with milestones (e.g. learn to teach) - define specific milestone and create due date

I will make at least 2 new connections in environmental policy per month. By the end of the semester I will a) grow my network on LinkedIn by at least 20 people, b) have list of at least 10 organizations am interested in, c) write a summary of the specific career paths I am most interested in.

Abilities

What abilities do you anticipate developing while pursuing this goal? These could be abilities you already have or areas that are completely new to you. Look over your goal so far. Notice the verbs you used when describing your activities, tasks, and criteria

I will develop my communication and interpersonal skills. By making connections with potential future colleagues, I will learn how to network. I will expand my career knowledge (learn about different paths) and learn about different work environments.

Relevant

Think about why you are committing to this goal. Why is it important to you? How does it fit with your personal and professional values? How will it help you to get closer to your definition of success and well-being?

My future career is an important part of my identity. Networking with professionals now will provide me with connections that I can reach out to later when I am applying for jobs. It is important to me that I develop professional relationships early so I am not stressed about the career transition later in my degree.

Tenable

Explain how you will ensure that this goal is doable. What resources or help will you need? Use IF/THEN statements to proactively overcome obstacles you might encounter.

I will not be graduating for at least a year, so I can do this slowly over the next few months. This is doable if I limit myself to 2 hours per week. IF I have trouble meeting people, THEN I will go to the McGill Career Planning Service for help.

Goal Title:

Specific

My goal is... The activities that will help me to get there are...

Goal Domain(s): ☐ Academic ☐ Personal Well-being ☐ Professional/Career Development

Measurable

I will know I have succeeded when... My due date or timeframe is...

Goal Type: ☐ Project ☐ Habit ☐ Development

Abilities

I will develop my abilities in...

Relevant

I want to pursue this goal because...

Tenable

I know this is doable because... I will need these resources / help from these people...
IF I encounter a challenge, THEN I will

Goal Title:

Specific

My goal is... The activities that will help me to get there are...

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IF I encounter a challenge, THEN I will

Assemble a Team

One of the most powerful ways to stay motivated (and accountable!) is to **share your goals with others**.

Identify a mentor, or consider creating a peer group that you can meet with regularly (monthly is ideal) to check in and share your progress. By sharing your progress and challenges with others, you can brainstorm ways to overcome obstacles, get advice on how to fulfill your aims, and celebrate your successes with others.

Use the space below to identify **3–5 people that could provide support**:



Create a Schedule

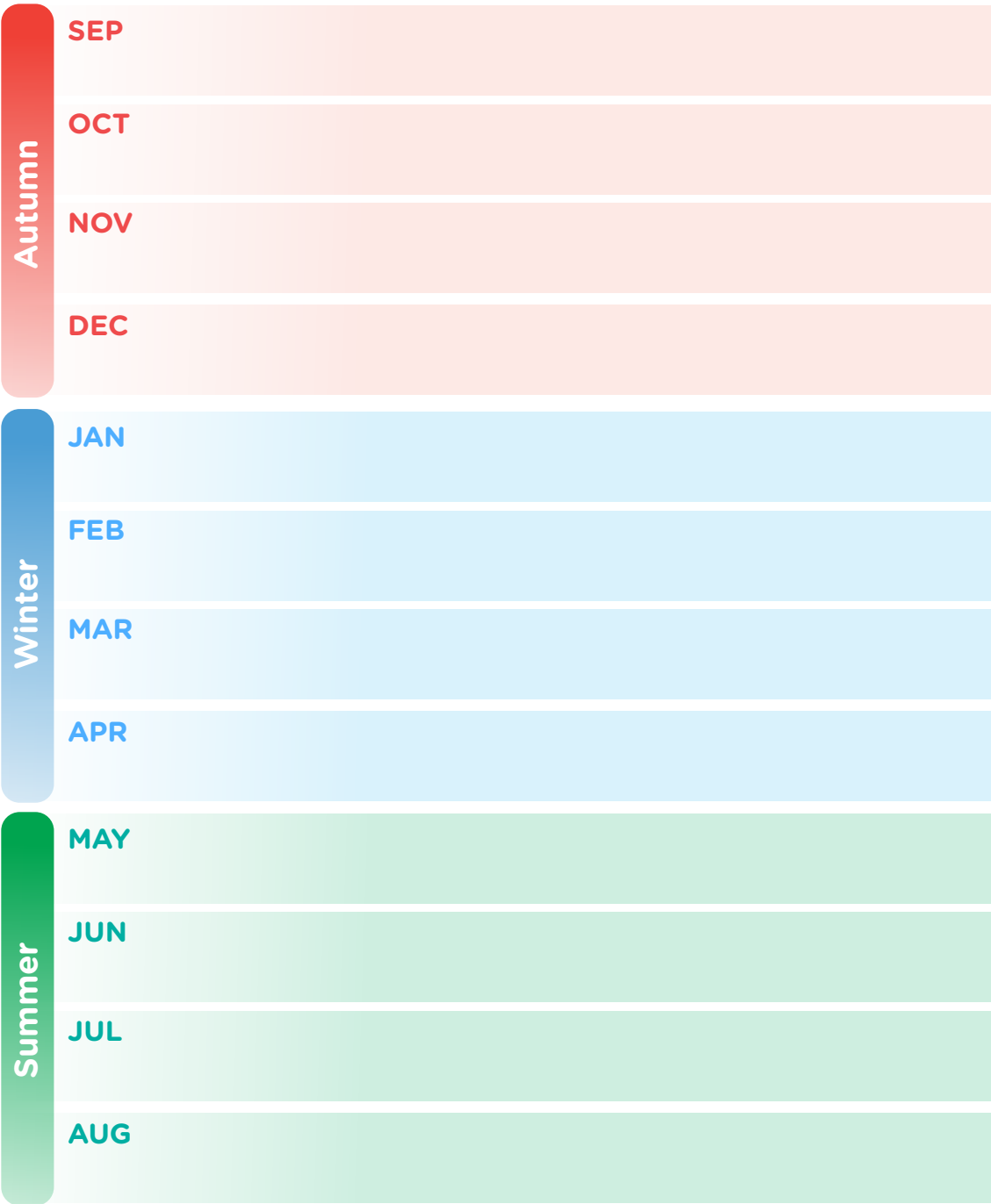
Sketch Out Your timeline

On the next page, start planning out when and how you want to work on these goals over the next year. Ideally you will create a due date for every activity and action, but remember: **it is extremely difficult to “plan your life”!** Being flexible will help you to adapt when challenges arise and seize opportunities that come your way.

Move Everything to Your Calendar

You can use an your own agenda or try the agenda templates in the Master Planner to further break down your goals and activities into monthly activities and weekly tasks. While you can't plan everything, using a calendar to track your goals will help you to assess your progress and get a realistic sense of how far along you are. In fact, it can be very motivating, as we often only evaluate progress based on our overall goals and forget to notice how much we are accomplishing every day!

Academic Year



Notes

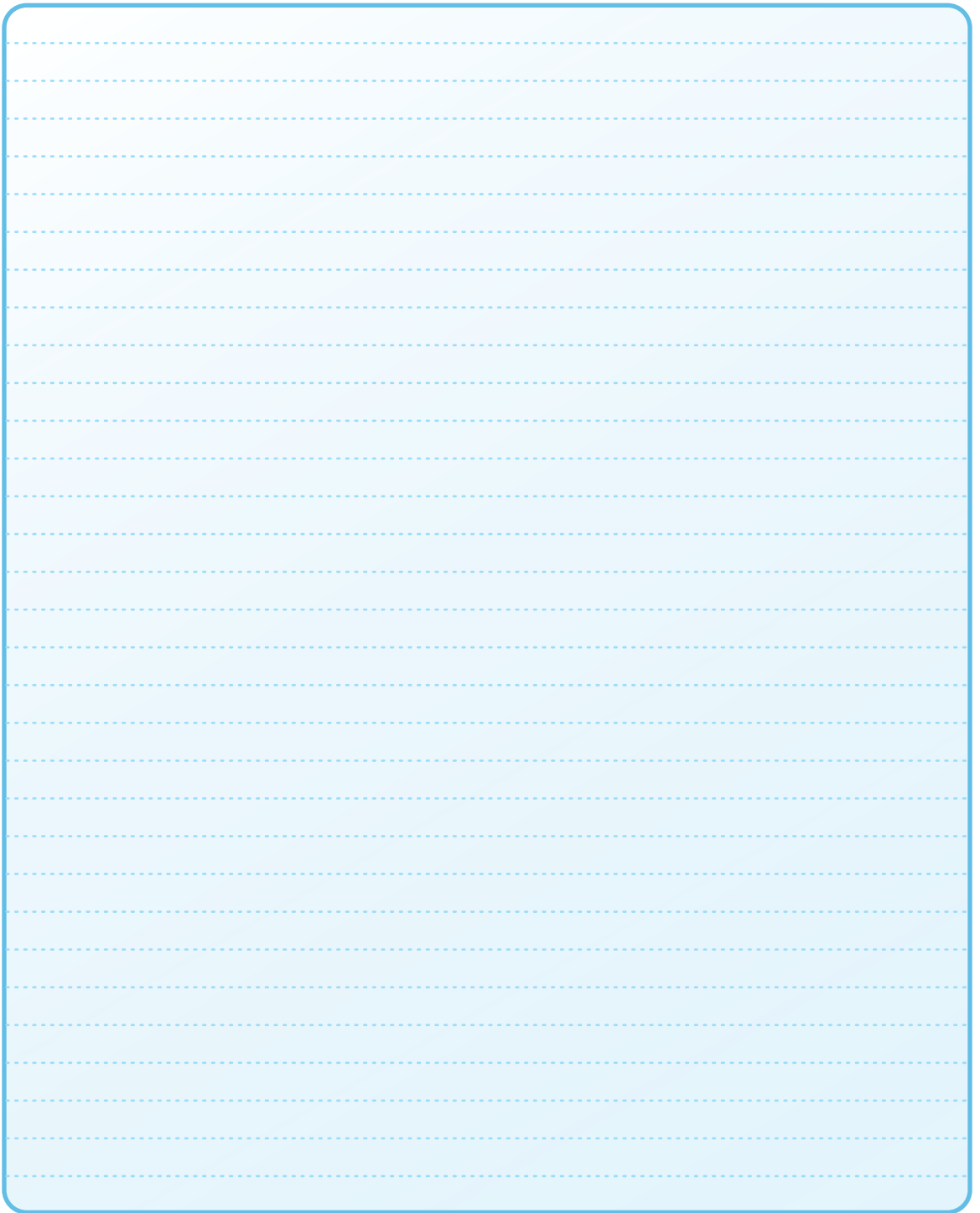
Use these pages to write down any reflections, notes, ideas, questions, or challenges that come up as you pursue your IDP.

If you need support or guidance to help you throughout the year, go to www.mcgill.ca/mypath/workshops for options.



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www.mcgill.ca/mypath



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Graduate and
Postdoctoral Studies